boarding the trains.[12] The letter was clearly intended for Ms Gandhi to come away as the premier saviour of migrants, fighting tooth and nail for their justice. The Central Railways had to come out clean on their cost break-up and specify that it was the states which had to cover the costs. With that being said, the fact remains that no money has been borne to date by any of the state Congress units for this purpose. Zilch.

There was one particular nail-biting episode where the Congress committed to arrange for a thousand busses to send migrants from Rajasthan to UP. Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, the Congress general secretary, urged the Yogi Adityanath government to make use of them. What is rather interesting about Mrs Gandhi Vadra is that she surfaces only when elections are around the corner or to create a controversy. In a way, it may be fair to even say that the party mostly uses her only to elevate matters in the national media narrative, possibly to gather more attention. In the quickly unfolding drama, politicizing the matter in a recorded video which she uploaded on social media, Mrs Gandhi Vadra urged the UP chief minister to use the buses, even if they had 'to put BJP stickers on them'. The permission for the buses to enter UP was denied by the Yogi government because many of them were junk vehicles registered as vehicles such as autorickshaws, cars and trucks; many were unsafe and the rest were uninsured. Allowing uninsured, unregistered vehicles into the state could possibly create a law-and-order problem and thus, in retaliation, the UP police filed an FIR against Mrs Gandhi Vadra's personal secretary for cheating and forging documents. Eventually, the Congress party yielded and recalled the deployed buses from the Rajasthan-UP border.[13]

The media developments which had occurred over the past two months since the migrants began to walk home, shortly after the announcement of the nationwide lockdown had been rather interesting. The unfortunate mass exodus was tracked and covered extensively in sections of the media. When it started to appear that the Congress and other opposition parties in the country were able to use this to attack the government over its failure to rehabilitate the migrants before the announcement of the lockdown, the international media too began to extensively cover the story. Pictures were published on a daily basis of tired, hungry, desperate migrants trying to walk back home. Stories of people dying on the roads due to dehydration or hunger were also extensively published with gut-wrenching videos. An interesting pattern came to be observed, Left-leaning international media